```
echo "outside swap function:\n";
echo "\$a is $a \n";
echo "\$b is $b \n";

swap($a, $b);

echo "outside swap function:\n";
echo "\$a is $a \n";
echo "\$b is $b \n";

?>
```

The swap function swaps the numbers between the $a and $b **variables**. The original variables are not affected.

```
$a = 4;
$b = 7;
```

At the beginning, these two variables are initiated.

```
swap($a, $b);
```

We call the swap() function. The function takes $a and $b variables as parameters.

```
$temp = $a;
$a = $b;
$b = $temp;
```

Inside the swap() function, we change the values. Note that the $a and $b variables are defined locally. They are valid only inside the swap() function.

```
$ php swap1.php
outside swap function:
$a is 4
$b is 7
inside swap function:
$a is 7
$b is 4
outside swap function:
$a is 4
```

Keyword

Variable is a storage location (identified by a memory address) paired with an associated symbolic name (an identifier), which contains some known or unknown quantity of information referred to as a value.